

Steve Swanson

A web veteran with experience in management, development, concept, design, marketing, teaching, and loving it all.

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EDUCATION

Bachelors, CIS
University of Wisconsin - Stevens Point
1994 – 1999

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- HTML
- JavaScript
- TypeScript
- React
- CSS (SASS, LESS, Stylus, Tailwind, etc)
- Next.js
- Gatsby
- Remix
- Node
- Express
- Webpack
- Storybook
- Enzyme
- Cypress
- Jest
- Playwright

PROGRAMS & SERVICES

- Jira
- Confluence
- Figma
- Optimizely
- LaunchDarkly
- Applitools
- Sentry
- Adobe CS
- Git
- GitLab
- NPM
- Yarn
- REST/SOAP
- Agile
- Windows, Mac, Linux

EXPERIENCE WITH

- AWS
- GCP
- Claude Code
- Contentful
- Firebase
- GraphQL
- MySQL
- PHP
- Python
- Supabase

AI TOOLING

- OpenAI SDK
- Structured LLM Output Pipelines
- AI Workflow Automation
- Claude Code

WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. ENGINEERING MANAGER

2022 – 2025

WGAC (Who Gives a Crap) | Remote

WGAC, better known as Who Gives a Crap, is an Australian based company that focuses on making consumer-based paper products with highly recyclable materials. I was initially hired as a senior software engineer to work with the director of engineering to create a true engineering department. After a year, I was dual-promoted to Staff Engineer as well as the US Engineering Manager.

- Redirected the department to lean into existing tool sets provided by Shopify rather than trying to create new ones from scratch, saving the company hundreds of thousands of dollars a year in service costs.
- Managed two US engineering departments, including internal hires as well as contractors from Bolivia.
- Worked with the Australian engineering departments to coordinate technical efforts and establish lines of communication.
- Presented initiatives to leadership and stakeholders to initiate buy-in, and kept them up to date on progress.
- Encouraged a culture where using AI to assist in day-to-day activities was normalized.

SENIOR UI ENGINEER

2020 – 2022

RxSaver/GoodRx | Austin, TX

I transferred into the RxSaver team which was owned by RetailMeNot and continued my work on the Anchor design system which RxSaver is largely based on. Then in mid-2021 RxSaver was purchased by GoodRx and I worked to integrate new services from that company into RxSaver's codebase.

- Upgraded RxSaver's installations of Webpack, Next.js and Node.js.
- Added the Osano consent management system to RxSaver's codebase and worked closely with the Osano team to resolve integration issues.
- Put forth and then implemented using Google Fonts for RxSaver rather than continue to use custom fonts, saving the company \$50k/month.

SENIOR UI ENGINEER/CODE2COLLEGE COORDINATOR

2018 – 2019

RetailMeNot | Austin, TX

Working in the Labs area, I served as the primary UI engineer for all experimental projects. These were test cases to prove or disprove possible new areas of revenue for the company. Later, I joined the Design Systems team creating React components for the Anchor design system, and I took the lead on developing our documentation site. I was also made the coordinator between RetailMeNot and Code2College, an organization devoted to bringing STEM opportunities to underprivileged high schoolers.

- Developed project 'Voltron' which combined multiple API's to create low price deals.
- Refactored an established API integration that pulled Best Buy deal data into RetailMeNot's iPhone/Android app, saving the company \$250k annually.
- Lead developer for RetailMeNot's design system's documentation site.
- Assembled a team within RetailMeNot to work with 4 Code2College interns in developing a custom project. Served as manager/teacher/mentor.

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REFERENCES

Available upon request

SENIOR FRONT END DEVELOPER

2016– 2017

NextWorks | Austin, TX

Developed, ideated, maintained and enhanced the company's primary product, Capsule Creator, a SPA (Single Page Application) used internally to create 'Content Capsules', or embeddable websites. These were able to be deployed as micro sites, iframed content for existing sites, or as rich media advertisements for Google DoubleClick.

- Worked with Bristol-Myers, Pfizer, Janssen Pharmaceuticals and more.
- Created an API to facilitate automated ad creation, saving the company \$50k annually.
- Taught classes for coworkers in the use of CSS/HTML.
- Created a UI/UX roadmap to take Capsule Creator from internal use to a customer-facing SaaS (System as a Service) product.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

2012– 2016

Spredfast/Mass Relevance | Austin, TX

Developed highly interactive data visualizations for the web for a wide variety of clients in an Agile environment. These sites were dynamic representations of data curated from many sources including Twitter (via their Firehose), Facebook, Google+, Instagram and other social media sites, and were fully mobile responsive and cross browser-friendly.

- Worked with NBA, Fox, E!, NFL, Discovery Channel, Fandango, Chick Fil A, Estee Lauder, IBM, US Open, Oakley, Schwab, Miss USA and more.
- Initiated a curriculum to bring new hires up to speed on the development stack and mentor junior developers.
- Served as project lead for all larger contracts
- Created and taught company-wide classes in CSS/HTML.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

2010 – 2012

CTC (Computer Technology Consultants) | Washington DC

Helped develop and maintain hundreds of CMS templates and scripts for the dozens of Department of State's Embassy websites in multiple languages, including Russian, Chinese, French, Spanish, Arabic & Persian.

- Created a web application that allowed users to create magazine-like layouts on the fly.
- Trained staff members in web technologies such as HTML, CSS, and jQuery.
- Developed PHP scripts to make API calls to an email notification service.
- Troubleshoot 508 compliance and cross-browser issues.

CREATIVE DIRECTOR

2005 – 2009

Plain Black | Remote

I worked for Plain Black as their senior graphic, web, and interactive designer which gave me creative control over everything from their website, online advertising, and print materials to the UI/UX for the company's CMS software product, WebGUI.

- Served as lead for the creative team, mentoring new designers and front-end developers.
- Maintained and added features to hundreds of templates for the company's CMS product.
- Traveled to client locations across the country to train them in CSS, HTML and templating.
- Wrote a 200 page book on design tricks and techniques, as well as examples of advanced templating in WebGUI.
- Spoke regularly at the WUC (WebGUI User's Conference) as an expert in design and CMS development.